effect. The organization will cramp itself into the new technology.

1.6.2 Team topologies

In the socio-technical architecture approach, as the name suggests, we are trying to codesign both the social and the technical architecture elements simultaneously. This way, we are thinking up front about all constraints and concerns.

This section is about the one main architecture method that is used today and within the data mesh community to do socio-technical architecture well. According to its website, “Team Topologies is a clear, easy-to-follow approach to modern software delivery with an emphasis on optimizing team interactions for flow” (https://teamtopologies.com). Matthew Skelton and Manuel Pais created Team Topologies, and they are starting to get some traction in the community because of their simplicity and straightforward application.

Team Topologies is an approach that helps you not to fall into the trap of Conway’s law. The Team Topologies framework is designed to optimize the teams inside a company for optimal flow. It relies heavily on the idea of cognitive load to properly split workloads across this flow and separates teams into just a few teams. It also separates interaction modes into ones that are designed to minimize cognitive load. Since Team Topologies is focused on the optimal flow of the company, it will help us to optimize the data-to-value flow inside the company.

1.6.3 Cognitive load

Cognitive load is a term from cognitive load theory and means the number of mental resources (working memory) used by a person. In the beginning, this theory was applied to the teaching field and influenced the way we write instructions so readers can easily digest them. Later it was used in a greater number of areas, including IT.

As socio-technical architects, we should shape our teams so that the total cognitive load is limited and is mostly reserved for the essential, value-creating activities. It is similar to road traffic: you will not maximize the